



Lumbar Puncture (Adult) Procedure

1. Scope

Site	Operational Area	Applicable to
Armada Kalamunda Group	All services	Nursing

2. Purpose

To provide safe nursing care to adult patients undergoing a lumbar puncture procedure. Paediatric patients refer to Perth Children's Hospital [Lumbar Puncture](#) clinical guideline.

3. Background

A lumbar puncture is a diagnostic procedure undertaken by medical staff. It is a sterile aseptic technique. It is performed by inserting a hollow needle into the subarachnoid space in the lumbar area (lower back usually between L3 -L5) of the spinal column. Specimens of cerebrospinal fluid are taken. Nursing staff are responsible for setting up the equipment, assisting the patient into the correct position and ensuring the specimens are sent off appropriately.

4. Equipment

- Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) as per standard precautions
- Sterile gloves
- Lumbar puncture pack
- Isopropyl alcohol 70% in chlorhexidine 2% solution (use alternative if patient has known allergy / hypersensitivity)
- Additional LP needles as requested by the medical officer
- 1 x syringe 2mL or 5mL (for local anaesthetic)
- 1 x drawing up needle
- 1 x 25g needle
- 1 x 22g needle
- Local anaesthetic
- Sharps container
- Specimen container
- Waterproof protector sheet (e.g. Bluey)
- Occlusive Dressing
- Consider alternatives if allergies to tapes / adhesives present

5. Procedure

- Ensure that the medical officer has obtained the necessary consent.
- Wash hands
- Prepare equipment
- Ensure area for procedure is well lit
- Check the patient identity matches consent and specimen labelling.
- Position patient and assist as required - foetal position or sitting on the edge of the bed hunched over the cardiac table and or pillows.
- For Paediatrics and Neonates- provide parents with the [Lumbar Puncture Health Facts](#) to assist with consent and education
- For information regarding the recommended tests to be requested on the Cerebrospinal Fluid (CSF) for Paediatrics and Neonates follow PCH [Meningitis](#) guidelines.
- Reinforce the importance of keeping still during the procedure
- Support the patient and observe for adverse outcomes throughout the procedure
- Assist the medical officer with the specimen containers as required
- Post procedure observations include 15/60 vital signs for 30 minutes, observe for leak at the site and report accordingly.
- Monitor Neuro vascular observation for any numbness, weakness & altered sensation.
- Keep Lumbar Puncture site dressing intact for 24 hours
- Lumbar Puncture site to be observed for 5 days for signs of infection.
- Patient may mobilise as able post procedure unless instructed by MO.
- Note- routine immobilisation post lumbar puncture does not reduce the incidence of post lumbar puncture headaches.
- Documentation of procedure in the integrated patient notes.

6. Legislative context

The following documents are required to give effect to this procedure:

- Health Department of Western Australia (HDWA) [Consent to Treatment Policy MP 0175/22](#)
- HDWA [Recognising and Responding to Acute Deterioration Policy MP 0171/22](#)
- East Metropolitan Health Service (EMHS) [Patient Identification and Procedure Matching EMHS: 21](#)

7. Supporting information

The following documents support the implementation of this procedure:

- [Specimen Collection and Pathology Results Procedure AKG-PRO-0421-13](#)
- [Diagnostic Results Management Policy AKG-POL-0088-21](#)
- [Aseptic Technique Procedure AKG 0045/24](#)
- [Recognition and Response to Acute Deterioration Policy AKG-POL-0388-22](#)
- [PCH Lumbar Puncture Guideline](#)

8. Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Compliance against this procedure will be monitored via:

- Monitoring of reported clinical incident data via Datix CIMS.

Specific findings are to be reported at the relevant departmental meeting for review and identification of any opportunities for improvement.

9. Relevant standards

National Safety and Quality Health Service (NSQHS) Standards (second edition):

- Standard 2 – Action 2.5 Healthcare rights and informed consent
- Standard 3 – Action 3.9 Aseptic technique
- Standard 6 – Action 6.5 Correct identification and procedure matching

10. Policy owner (relating to these procedures)

Enquiries relating to this procedure may be directed to:

Title: Coordinator of Nursing
 Department: Medical
 Email: jane.husain@health.wa.gov.au

11. Review

This procedure will be reviewed and evaluated as required to ensure relevance and currency. At a minimum it will be reviewed within one (1) year after first issue and at least every three (3) years thereafter.

Version	Effective from	Effective to	Amendment(s)
3	09/07/2024	09/07/2027	

12. Authorisation

This procedure has been authorised and issued by the Director Nursing and Midwifery.

Authorised by	Helen Fullarton – Director of Nursing and Midwifery
Authorisation date	09/07/2024
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